Amivantamab (Rybrevant®) and lazertinib (Lazcluze®)

Amivantamab (Rybrevant®) and lazertinib (Lazcluze®) is a cancer drug treatment. It is used to treat lung cancer.

On this page

- What is amivantamab (Rybrevant®) and lazertinib (Lazcluze®)?
- Having amivantamab and lazertinib
- About side effects
- Side effects while treatment is being given
- Very common side effects
- Other side effects
- Other important information
- How we can help

What is amivantamab (Rybrevant®) and lazertinib (Lazcluze®)?

Amivantamab (Rybrevant®) and lazertinib (Lazcluze®) can be used to treat non-small cell lung cancer (NSCLC) when the cancer cells have a gene change called EGFR (epidermal growth factor receptor). This gene change makes an abnormal form of the EGFR protein, which makes cancer cells grow.

Amivantamab is a type of targeted therapy drug called a bispecific monoclonal antibody. It targets the EGFR gene. Lazertinib is also a targeted therapy drug called a cancer growth inhibitor. It blocks signals from EGFR to the cancer cells and stops them growing. This treatment is used to treat advanced NSCLC.

It is best to read this information with our information about targeted therapies for lung cancer.

Your cancer team will talk to you about this treatment and its possible side effects before you agree (consent) to have treatment.

More information about this treatment

This information is correct at time of publishing. But sometimes the types of cancer this treatment is used for, or treatment side effects, may change between revision dates.

You can talk to your cancer team if you want more detailed information about this treatment. Or visit the electronic Medicines Compendium (eMC) website, which has patient information leaflets (PIL) for individual drugs.

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Having amivantamab and lazertinib

You have amivantamab as an injection under the skin (subcutaneously). You usually have it in a day unit or clinic as an outpatient.

Lazertinib comes in tablets. This means you can take it at home.

During a course of treatment, you will meet someone from your cancer team, such as a:

- cancer doctor
- specialist nurse
- specialist pharmacist.

This is who we mean when we mention doctor, nurse or pharmacist in this information.

During your course of treatment, you will have regular blood tests. This is to check that it is safe for you to have treatment.

You will meet with a doctor, nurse or pharmacist before you have treatment. They will talk to you about your blood results and ask how you have been feeling.

Your nurse will give you amivantamab as an injection under the skin over several minutes. They give it into the tummy area. Tell the nurse if you have any pain while having the injection.

Your course of treatment

Your cancer team will discuss your treatment plan with you.

Your injections of amivantamab may be weekly to start with and then every 2 or 3 weeks. You take lazertinib every day, usually in the morning. When you have amivantamab and lazertinib on the same day you always have lazertinib first.

Your cancer team may also give you anti-sickness drugs and other medicines to take home. Take these exactly as they tell you to.

Taking lazertinib tablets

Your cancer team will give you the tablets to take home. They may give you tablets of different strengths. Always take the tablets exactly as explained. This is important to make sure they work as well as possible for you. You can take the tablets with or without food.

Make sure you:

- swallow them whole with a glass of water
- do not chew, open or crush them
- take them at the same time every day.

If you forget to take the tablets, take the missed dose as soon as possible if it is more than 12 hours until your next dose. If it is less than 12 hours, you can skip the missed dose and take your next dose at the usual time. Do not take a double dose. Contact the hospital on the 24-hour number you have been given for advice.

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Other things to remember about your tablets:

- Keep them in the original package and at room temperature, away from moisture, heat and direct sunlight.
- Keep them safe, where children cannot see or reach them.
- If you are sick (vomit) just after taking them, do not take an extra dose. Take your next dose at the usual time.
- Do not throw away unused tablets. Return them to your cancer team at the hospital.

About side effects

We explain the most common side effects of this treatment here. We also include some that are less common.

You may get some of the side effects we mention, but you are unlikely to get all of them. And you may have some side effects, including rarer ones, that we have not listed here.

Other cancer treatments may cause different side effects. If you are also having other cancer treatment, you may have other side effects.

Always tell your doctor, nurse or pharmacist about any side effects you have. They can give you:

- drugs to help control some side effects
- advice about managing side effects.

It is important to take any drugs exactly as explained. This means they will be more likely to work for you.

Serious and life-threatening side effects

Some cancer treatments can cause serious side effects. Sometimes, these may be life-threatening. Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist can explain the risk of these side effects to you.

Contact the hospital

Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist will give you 24-hour contact numbers for the hospital. If you feel unwell or need advice, you can call at any time of the day or night. Save these numbers in your phone or keep them somewhere safe.

Side effects while treatment is being given

Some people have side effects while they are having this treatment or shortly after they have it.

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Allergic reaction

Some people have an allergic reaction, especially with the first injection of amivantamab. Before treatment, you will have medicines to help prevent or reduce any reaction.

Signs of a reaction include:

- feeling hot or flushed
- shivering
- feeling breathless or wheezy
- feeling sick
- pain in your chest.

Your nurse will check you for signs of a reaction during your injection. If you feel unwell or have any of these signs, tell them straight away. If you do have a reaction, they can treat it quickly.

Sometimes a reaction happens a few hours after treatment. If you develop any of these signs or feel unwell after you get home, contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number.

Always call 999 if swelling happens suddenly or you are struggling to breathe.

Injection site

You may have some swelling in the area of the injection site. if you have white skin, the area may become red. If you have brown or black skin, the area may become darker than the surrounding skin. Tell your cancer team if you are worried about this.

Very common side effects

These side effects happen to 10 or more people in every 100 people (10% or more) who have this treatment.

Feeling sick

You may feel sick during this treatment, but this is usually mild. Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist may prescribe you anti-sickness drugs to help prevent or control sickness. Take the drugs exactly as they tell you to. If you feel sick, take small sips of fluid often and eat small amounts regularly. It is important to drink enough fluids.

If you continue to feel sick, or if you are sick (vomit) 1 to 2 times in 24 hours, contact the hospital on the 24-hour number as soon as possible. They will give you advice.

Tummy pain

You may get pain in your tummy (abdomen). Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist can give you advice or treatment to help. Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number if your symptoms do not go away or get worse.

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Constipation

This treatment can cause constipation. Constipation means that you are not able to pass stools (poo) as often as you normally do. It can become difficult or painful. Here are some tips that may help:

- Drink at least 2 litres (3½ pints) of fluids each day.
- Eat high-fibre foods, such as fruit, vegetables and wholemeal bread.
- Do regular gentle exercise, like going for short walks.

If you have constipation, contact the hospital on the 24-hour number for advice. They can give you drugs called laxatives to help.

If you have not been able to pass stools for over 2 days and are being sick, contact the 24-hour number straight away.

Diarrhoea

This treatment may cause diarrhoea. Diarrhoea means passing more stools (poo) than is normal for you, or having watery or loose stools. You may also have stomach cramps. If you have a stoma, it may be more active than usual.

If you are passing loose stools 3 or more times a day and this is not normal for you, contact the hospital as soon as possible on the 24-hour number. Follow the advice they give you about:

- taking anti-diarrhoea medicines
- drinking enough fluids to keep you hydrated and to replace lost salts and minerals
- any changes to your diet that might help.

They might also ask you for a specimen of your stool to check for infection.

Loss of appetite

This treatment can affect your appetite. Don’t worry if you do not eat much for 1 or 2 days. But if your appetite does not come back after a few days, or if you are losing weight, tell your doctor, nurse or pharmacist. They can give you advice. They may give you food or drink supplements. Or they may suggest changes to your diet or eating habits to help.

Sore mouth and throat

This treatment may cause a sore mouth and throat. You may also get mouth ulcers. This can make you more likely to get a mouth or throat infection. Use a soft toothbrush to clean your teeth or dentures in the morning, at night and after meals.

Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number, if:

- a sore mouth or throat affects how much you can drink or eat
- your mouth, tongue, throat or lips have any blisters, ulcers or white patches.

They can give you advice, and mouthwash or medicines to help with the pain or to treat any infection. Follow their advice and make sure you:

- drink plenty of fluids

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- avoid alcohol and tobacco
- avoid food or drinks that irritate your mouth and throat.

Feeling tired

Feeling tired is a common side effect of this treatment. Try to pace yourself and plan your day so you have time to rest. Gentle exercise, like short walks, can help you feel less tired.

If you feel sleepy, do not drive or use machinery.

High temperature

This treatment may cause a high temperature (pyrexia). A high temperature is also a sign of infection. It is important to get any infection treated as soon as possible.

If you have any signs of an infection, tell your doctor, nurse or pharmacist. These signs include:

- a sore throat
- diarrhoea
- needing to pass urine (pee) often, or discomfort when you pass urine.

Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number if you have any of these symptoms:

- a temperature above 37.5°C
- a temperature below 36°C
- you feel unwell, even with a normal temperature.

Skin changes

This treatment can cause difficult skin changes, such as an acne-like itchy rash, dry skin and small, pus-filled spots on the scalp. Because of this, your cancer team will give you skin care advice to reduce the risk of severe skin changes. It is important to follow their advice.

You may be given a pack that includes:

- moisturising cream
- an antiseptic wash
- antibiotics to take to prevent skin infection
- antibiotic creams.

It is important to protect your skin from the sun during treatment and for 2 months after treatment finishes. To protect your skin in the sun:

- use suncream with an SPF (sun protection factor) of 30 or higher
- stay in the shade
- cover up with clothing and a hat.

This treatment may also affect the nerves and cause changes in sensation such as numbness, tingling or pain in your hands or feet

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Contact the hospital on the 24-hour number if you notice any skin changes or changes in sensation in your hands or feet.

Nail changes

This treatment can also affect your nails. It may cause infection in the skin around your nails. You will be given information on how to look after your nails to protect them. This will be included in the advice on skin care you are given.

If the skin around your nails becomes sore and swollen, contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number.

Effects on the eyes

Tell your doctor, nurse or pharmacist if your eyes feel sore, red or dry during treatment. They can prescribe eye drops to help.

Sometimes eye problems can be serious. Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number, if you have:

- swelling or pain in the eyes
- eyesight changes
- eyes that are sensitive to light.

Your eyelashes may also grow longer, curlier or turn inwards. Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist can advise you if your eyelashes are irritating your eyes.

Effects on the liver

This treatment can affect how the liver works. You will have regular blood tests to check this. Sometimes liver changes can be serious. Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number if you have any of these symptoms:

- yellow skin or eyes
- feeling very sleepy
- dark urine (pee)
- unexplained bleeding or bruising
- pain in the right side of your tummy (abdomen).

If you have black or brown skin, changes in your skin colour may be less noticeable. You might first notice the whites of your eyes look yellow, or that the colour of your urine has changed.

Muscle pain

You may get pain in your muscles with this treatment. If this happens, tell your doctor, nurse or pharmacist. They can give you painkillers and advice.

If you have muscle pain, try:

- placing a heat pad or covered hot water bottle against the painful area
- taking warm baths

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- planning your activities to include regular rests.

Fluid build-up

This treatment can cause a build-up of fluid in the body. This will slowly get better after treatment ends. Contact the hospital on the 24-hour number if you:

- are gaining weight
- have swelling in your face, legs or ankles.

They can give you advice and treatment to help.

Low levels of protein or minerals in the blood

This treatment may cause low levels of protein, potassium, magnesium or calcium in the blood. You will have regular blood tests to check these.

Blood clot risk

This treatment can increase the risk of a blood clot. Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number if you have any of these symptoms during or after treatment:

- throbbing pain or swelling in a leg or arm
- reddening of the skin in the area – if you have black or brown skin, this can be harder to notice, but the skin might become darker
- suddenly feeling breathless or coughing.

Always call 999 if you have:

- chest pain
- difficulty breathing.

A blood clot is serious, but it can be treated with drugs called anticoagulants. These thin the blood. You may be given drugs to reduce the risk of getting a blood clot for the first few months of your treatment.

Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist can give you more information about preventing and treating blood clots.

Other side effects

These side effects happen to less than 10 in 100 people (less than 10%) who have this treatment. Some of them are much rarer than this but they are still important to know about. Rare means a side effect that happens to less than 1 in 1,000 people (less than 0.1%).

Serious skin changes

Rarely, this treatment can cause a serious skin reaction that needs to be treated immediately in hospital.

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Do not take any more of this treatment and contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number if you have any of these symptoms:

- a skin rash that is spreading
- blistering or peeling skin
- flu-like symptoms, such as a high temperature and joint pain
- sores on your lips or in your mouth.

Effects on the lungs

This treatment can cause inflammation of the lungs. This is called pneumonitis. Contact the hospital straight away on the 24-hour number if you notice any of these changes during treatment or after it ends:

- breathlessness
- a cough that does not go away
- wheezing
- a fever, with a temperature over 37.5°C.

You should also tell them if any existing breathing problems get worse. You may have:

- tests to check your lungs
- treatment, if needed.

Other important information

Driving

This treatment may make you feel tired, dizzy, and can affect your vision. Do not drive or use machinery until these side effects improve. If you are worried about this, contact your doctor, nurse or pharmacist.

Other medicines

Some medicines can affect how this treatment works or be harmful while you are having it. Always tell your cancer doctor, nurse or pharmacist about any drugs you are taking or planning to take, such as:

- medicines you have been prescribed
- medicines you buy in a shop, pharmacy or online
- vitamins or supplements
- herbal drugs and complementary or homeopathic therapies
- recreational drugs – for example, cannabis.

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Vaccinations

Cancer doctors usually recommend that people with cancer have vaccinations for flu and coronavirus (covid). They may also recommend other vaccines, such as Shingrix® for shingles. These all help reduce your risk of serious illness from these infections. Most people can have these vaccines, including people with weak immune systems.

You should not have live vaccines if your immune system is weak. This includes if you are having or recently had chemotherapy, radiotherapy or other cancer treatments that affect your immune system. Live vaccines can make you unwell because they contain a very weak version of the illness they protect you against. There are several live vaccines, including the yellow fever vaccine.

It is important to ask your doctor, nurse or pharmacist for advice about having vaccinations. They can explain what vaccines are right for you and when it is best to have them.

Contraception

Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist will advise you not to get pregnant or make someone pregnant while having this treatment and for some time afterwards. The drugs may harm a developing baby. It is important to use contraception to prevent pregnancy. Follow their advice about:

- what types of contraception to use
- how long after treatment you should continue to use contraception.

Breastfeeding

You are advised not to breastfeed while having this treatment, or for some time after treatment ends. This is because the drugs could be passed to the baby through breast milk.

Your doctor, nurse or pharmacist can give you more information.

Fertility

Some cancer drugs can affect whether you can get pregnant or make someone pregnant. If you are worried about this, it is important to talk with your doctor before you start treatment.

Medical and dental treatment

If you need medical treatment for any reason other than cancer, always tell the healthcare professional that you are having cancer treatment. Give them the contact details for your cancer doctor or cancer team so they can ask for advice.

If you have appointments with a dentist, always tell them you are having cancer treatment. Talk to your cancer team before you have any dental treatment.

About our information

This information has been written, revised and edited by Macmillan Cancer Support's Cancer Information Development team. It has been reviewed by expert medical and health professionals and people living with cancer.

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References

Visit the electronic Medicines Compendium (eMC) to download a Patient Information Leaflet (PIL) for more detailed information. The leaflet lists all known side effects.

Cancer Information Development team

Author

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Our cancer information meets the PIF TICK quality mark.

This means it is easy to use, up-to-date and based on the latest evidence. Learn more about how we produce our information.

The language we use

We want everyone affected by cancer to feel our information is written for them.

We want our information to be as clear as possible. To do this, we try to:

- use plain English
- explain medical words
- use short sentences
- use illustrations to explain text
- structure the information clearly
- make sure important points are clear.

We use gender-inclusive language and talk to our readers as ‘you’ so that everyone feels included. Where clinically necessary we use the terms ‘men’ and ‘women’ or ‘male’ and ‘female’. For example, we do so when talking about parts of the body or mentioning statistics or research about who is affected.

You can read more about how we produce our information here.

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How we can help

How to print a PDF from this website

Instructions on how you can make a PDF version of this page using the print function on your browser.

Clinical Information Nurse Specialists

Our Cancer Information Nurse Specialists are dedicated cancer nurses available to talk to on our Macmillan Cancer Support Line.

Call us free on 0808 808 0000

8am to 8pm, 7 days a week. You can talk to our cancer specialists about anything.

Email the Macmillan Support Line

Email the Macmillan Support Team if you have any questions.

Chat online

Available 8am to 7.45pm, 7 days a week. For confidential, real-time support if you don’t want to call.

Online Community

Chat online anonymously to others who understand what you are going through. Our community is available 24/7 and has dedicated forums where you can get advice and ask our experts.

Find cancer support services in your area

What's going on near you? Find out about support groups, where to get information and how to get involved with Macmillan where you live.

Get help

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